

Sanctification



A man pulls a clean robe over a stained shirt, and he is glad to do it. He is not hiding. He is dressing for a new identity that is already his.

Before you gather

- Read Day 27, Sanctification, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read Colossians 3:1–4, 12–14 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.
- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.

- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 · ICEBREAKER · 7 MIN

Open the room

What jacket, uniform, or jersey changed how you carried yourself the day you put it on?

Leader. An identity you wear. The book already asked them to define positional and progressive sanctification, and to list sins to take off. Do not quiz the journal. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 · THE WORD · 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: Sanctification is not a costume and not the same gift as justification. God has already set His people apart: washed, sanctified, justified. And He is making them like Christ. Already His. Not yet finished. God gave the growth. We obey.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

Sanctification means God has set you apart as holy and His, and now He is making you more like Jesus.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Greek *hagiasmos* — holiness, consecration, being set apart as God's.

MEMORY VERSE · 1 CORINTHIANS 6:11

And such were some of you. But you were washed, you were sanctified, you were justified in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ and by the Spirit of our God.

Together, open the flashcard for Sanctification. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

Colossians 3:1–4, 12–14

Paul begins with “you have been raised with Christ,” then tells them what to put on. The order is the doctrine. Commands land on people who already belong to God. Holiness here is how they treat one another, not a private mood.

If then you have been raised with Christ, seek the things that are above, where Christ is, seated at the right hand of God. Set your minds on things that are above, not on things that are on earth. For you have died, and your life is hidden with Christ in God. When Christ who is your life appears, then you also will appear with him in glory. Put on then, as God’s chosen ones, holy and beloved, compassionate hearts, kindness, humility, meekness, and patience, bearing with one another... And above all these put on love, which binds everything together in perfect harmony.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. What does Paul say is already true of them before he tells them to put anything on?

CORE

Leader. Raised with Christ. Died with Him. Life hidden with Christ. Chosen, holy, and beloved. The command comes to people God has already set apart. He is not waiting to see if He likes them.

2. Look at the list in verses 12–14. Are these mostly private feelings, or ways of treating other people?

Leader. Mostly ways of treating people: compassion, kindness, humility, meekness, patience, bearing with one another, love. Holiness shows up in the room. We follow the Spirit by obeying this Word, not by chasing a feeling of being holy.

4 · AROUND THE ROOM · 20 MIN

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. 1 Corinthians 6:11 puts washed, sanctified, and justified in the past tense: “such were some of you.” How should a Christian speak about the past: as if it never

happened, or as if it is no longer in charge? CORE

Leader. Paul names the old life, then says “were.” Tell the truth. Do not let the old life keep the name. Justification is the verdict. Sanctification, in this verse, is the new standing. They are distinct. Both are God’s. Neither is our polish.

4. Philippians 2:12–13: work out your salvation, for it is God who works in you to will and to work. Where do we slide into “God does it, so I will not” or “I do it, so it depends on me”?

Leader. Both slides deny the verse. We work because He works. Effort is not earning. Sitting still is not faith. God gave the growth. We obey.

5. Colossians 3:4 says Christ is your life, and that you will appear with Him in glory. What would change this month if holiness meant becoming who you already are in Him, not becoming someone God might finally accept?

Leader. Fear-based change wears people out. You are already His. You are not finished. That is sanctification, and it is not justification. You can tie it to adoption without reteaching the whole doctrine.

5 • SAY IT • 5 MIN

In one sentence

Sanctification means God has set His people apart as His, and He is making them like Jesus: already His, not yet finished.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 • THIS WEEK • 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before

you pray.

Let someone who does not follow Jesus see you still being changed. Apologize where you were wrong, and serve them. Tell them God has set His people apart in Christ and is making them like Jesus. Already His. Not finished.

Leader. An honest unfinished place will say more than a victory speech. Name Christ. Do not confuse sanctification with earning justification. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

7 • PRAY • 8 MIN

Pray these, and leave room for others

1. Thank God that “holy and beloved” is already what He calls His people in Christ.
2. Ask for one virtue from Colossians 3, and name it, to be put on this week toward a real person.
3. Ask Him to keep working in you, so your effort is obedience and not panic.

Before you stumble

Two errors meet at the end of Part IV. One hears “already holy” and stops fighting sin. One hears “become holy” and lives condemned. First Corinthians 6:11 will not hold either. Progress is real and uneven. Do not promise a new personality by next month. Do not call a sin this passage tells you to put away “just your wiring.” If you need the put-off list, read Colossians 3:5–9. Do not make people share it. Keep the distinction: justification declares the believer righteous in Christ.

Sanctification sets him apart and makes him like Christ. Already His. Not yet finished.

WITH STUDENTS

Ask what team gear does to how they play. Then ask what it means to practice as someone already on the roster in Christ, not as someone auditioning for God’s favor every day.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

Romans 6:11–14, if they want the fight stated plainly: count yourselves dead to sin and alive to God, and do not let sin reign. Hebrews 10:14 holds both sides: He has perfected for all time those who are being sanctified. Distinct from the verdict, and not yet the finish.